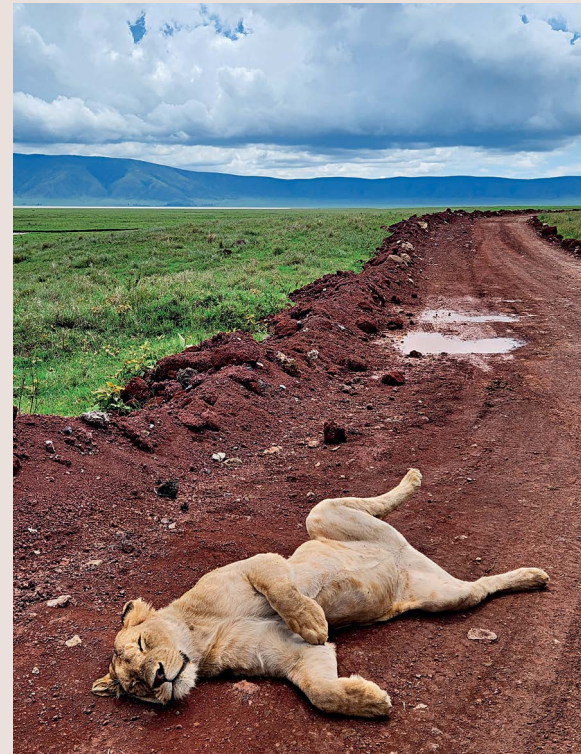




PERKS OF WORK For Vishal Gondal, CEO and Founder of GOQii, a change of scenery often stirs up new ideas



INQUISITIVE WANDERER

Novelist Henry Miller says one's destination is never a place, but a new way of seeing things. Inspired, Vishal Gondal has perfected the art of getting more out of his work trips

BY NIDHI SINGAL

WHILE MANY C-SUITE executives travel frequently for work, only a few seize the opportunity to transform their journeys into a personal exploration. For Vishal Gondal, CEO and Founder of tech-enabled healthcare platform GOQii, work commitments take him on international trips almost once every two months. That's how his passion for exploring new cultures and cuisines turns his business trips into adventures as well.

More than just the thrill of visiting new places, travelling for him is a journey of learning, experiencing and growing, filled with unforgettable moments and invaluable lessons that remain with him long after he has returned. (It helps that Gondal is an avid photographer.) For instance, on a recent business trip to Japan, apart from his meetings, he relished sushi, immersed himself in the tranquil beauty of traditional Japanese gardens, and also delved into history by visiting temples.

Over the years, Gondal has travelled to numerous exotic places

around the world—such as Iceland, Ladakh, Kenya and Tanzania—that are known for their culture, landscape, food and wildlife, among other things. “While each trip has left a mark on me, the recent experience that stands out the most was the safari in Tanzania. The chance to witness majestic lions, graceful giraffes and other wild animals in their natural habitats amidst the unspoilt landscapes of Tanzania was truly memorable.”

His safari in Tanzania was not only a holiday, but also proved to be a profound learning experience. “Ob-